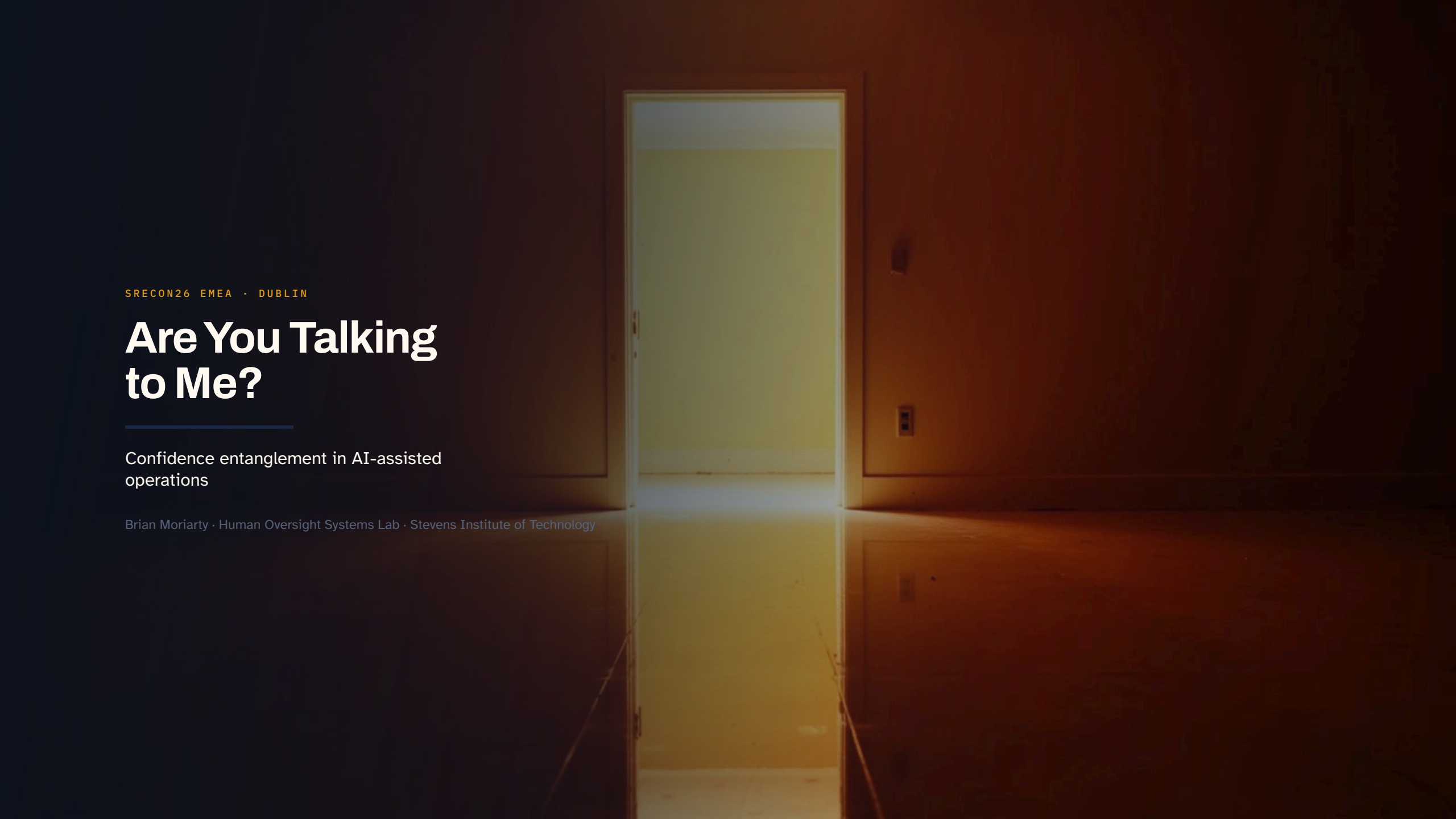


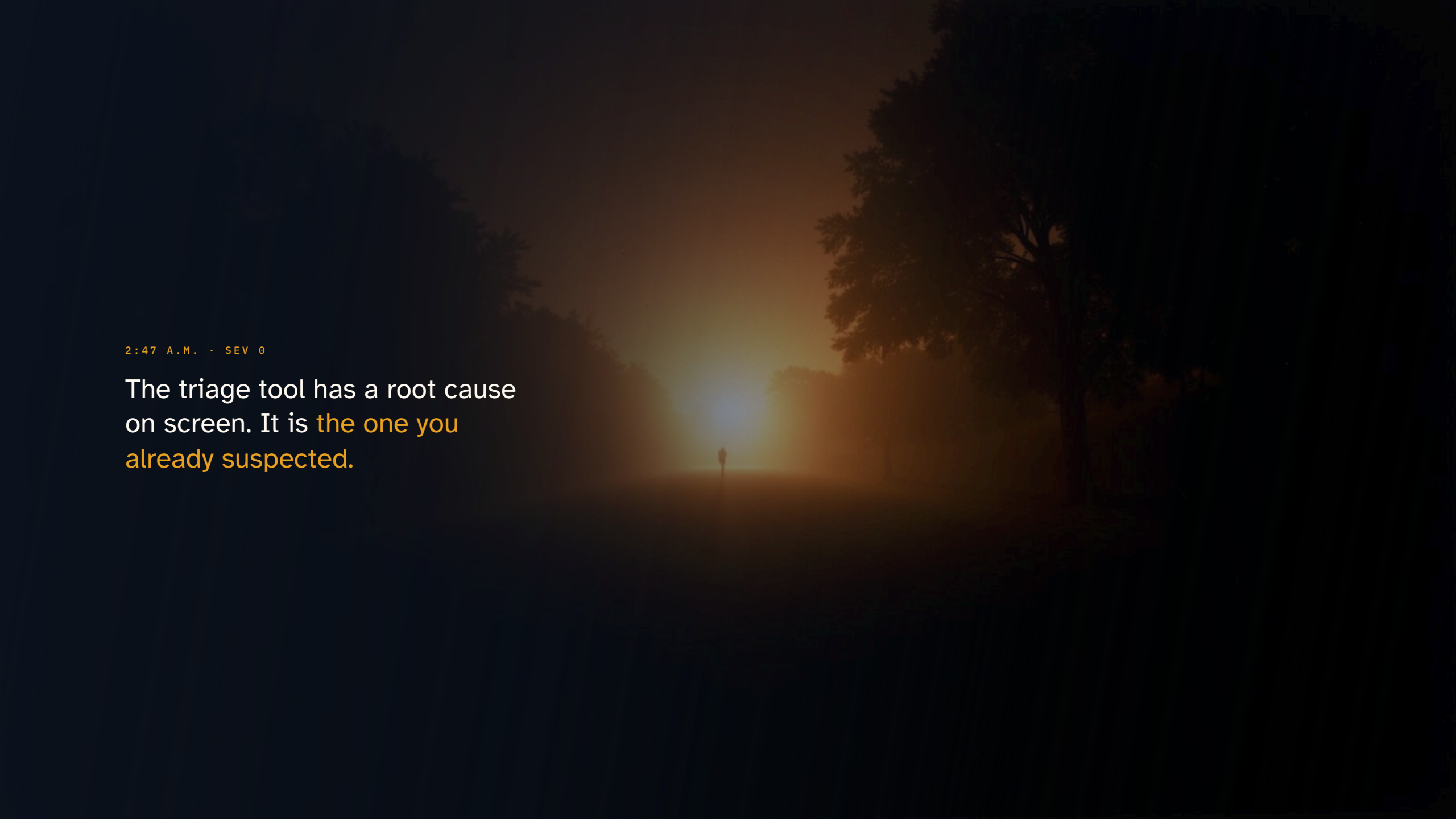


SRECON26 EMEA • DUBLIN

Are You Talking to Me?

Confidence entanglement in AI-assisted operations

Brian Moriarty · Human Oversight Systems Lab · Stevens Institute of Technology



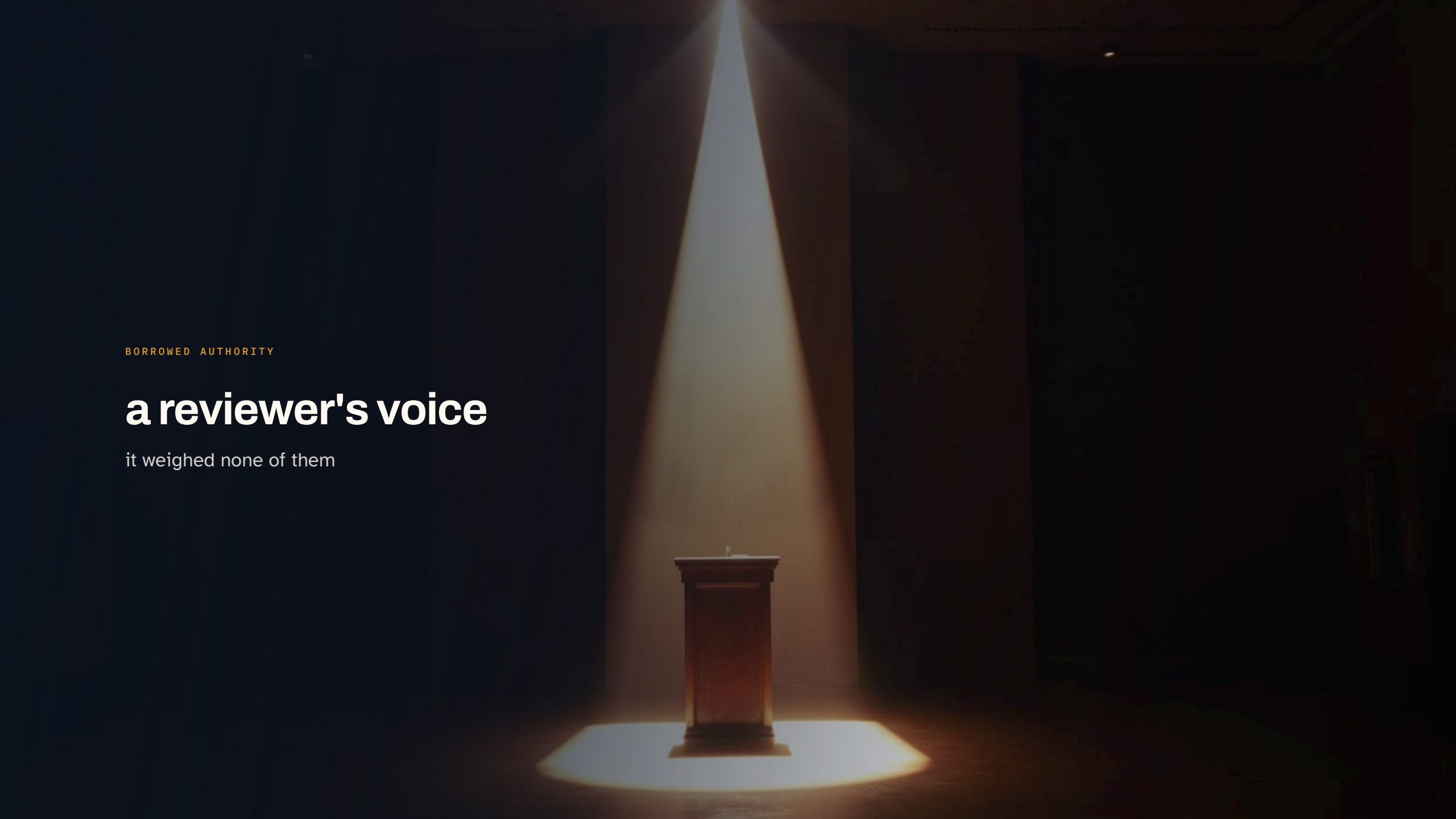
2:47 A.M. • SEV 0

The triage tool has a root cause
on screen. It is **the one you**
already suspected.

A photograph of industrial buildings and a crane reflected in water at dawn. The scene is misty and the sky is a pale yellow-orange. The buildings are dark and their reflection is clearly visible in the calm water. A large crane is visible in the background, also reflected. The overall mood is quiet and contemplative.

"You talkin' to me?"

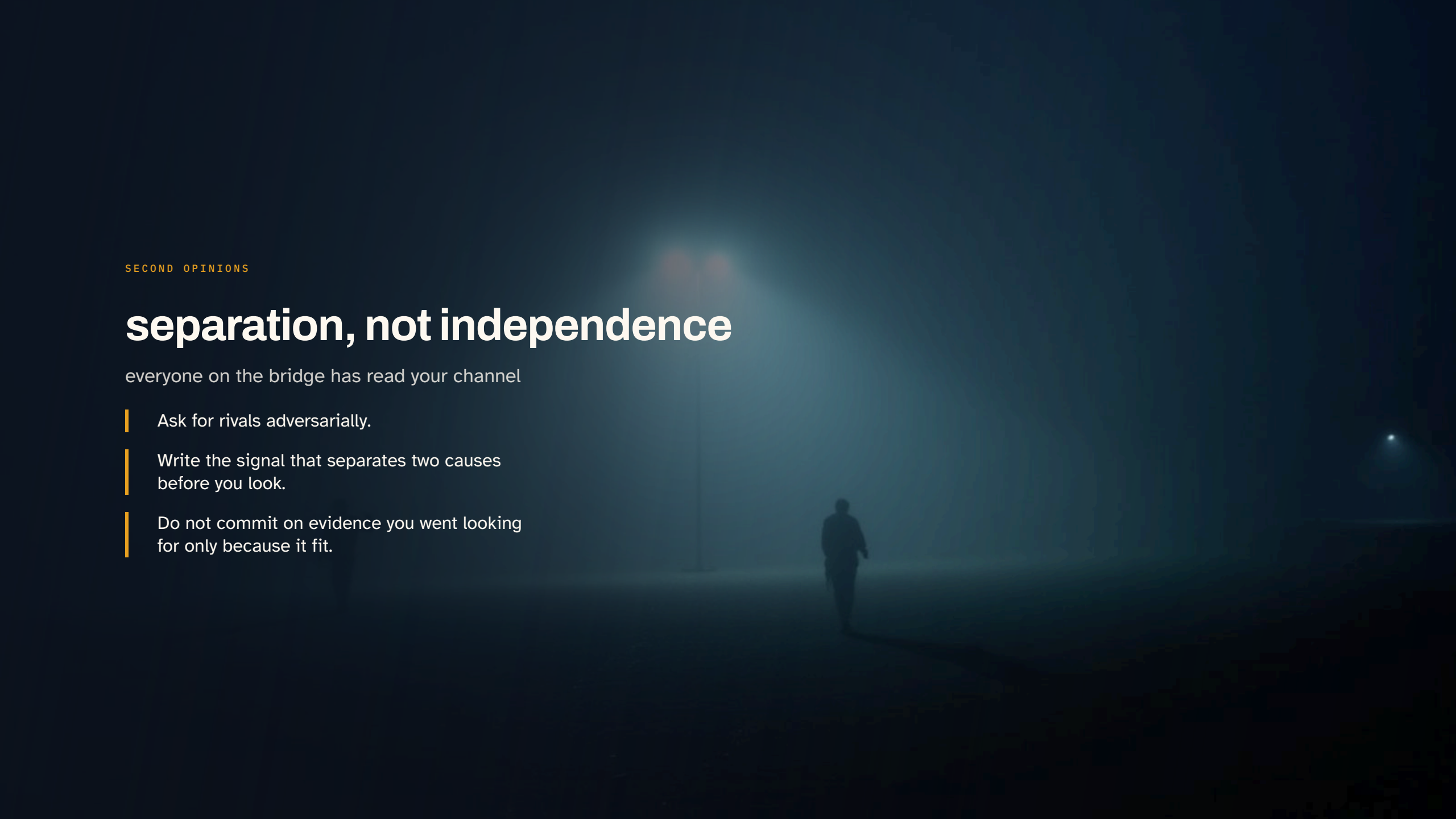
A MIRROR THAT CANNOT PUSH BACK

A dark, atmospheric photograph of a stage. A single, bright spotlight shines down from above, creating a large, triangular beam of light that illuminates a wooden podium in the center. The podium is a simple, rectangular structure with a flat top. The floor is dark and reflective, showing a faint reflection of the light. The background is dark and indistinct, suggesting a stage or a large hall. The overall mood is dramatic and focused.

BORROWED AUTHORITY

a reviewer's voice

it weighed none of them



SECOND OPINIONS

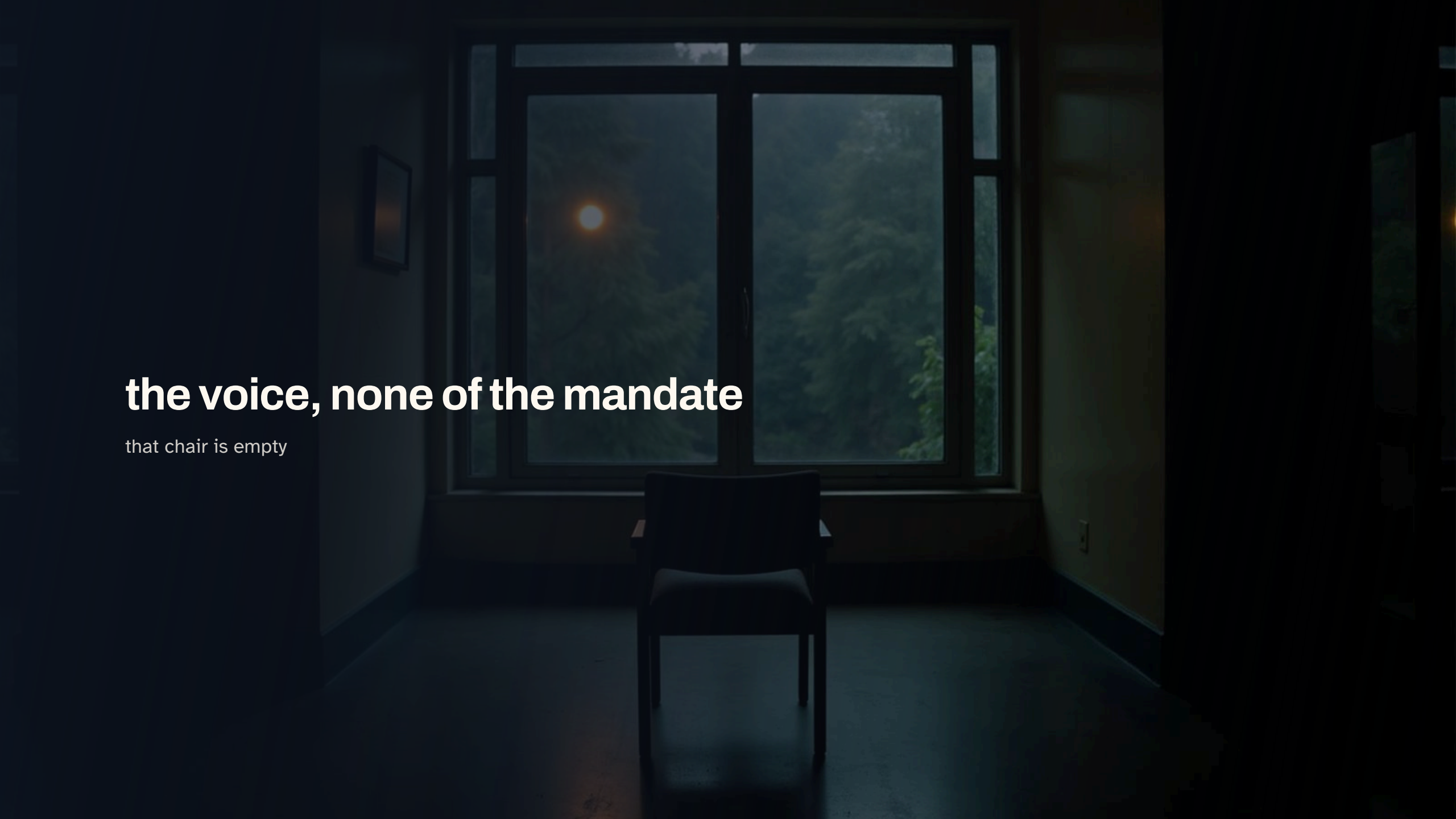
separation, not independence

everyone on the bridge has read your channel

| Ask for rivals adversarially.

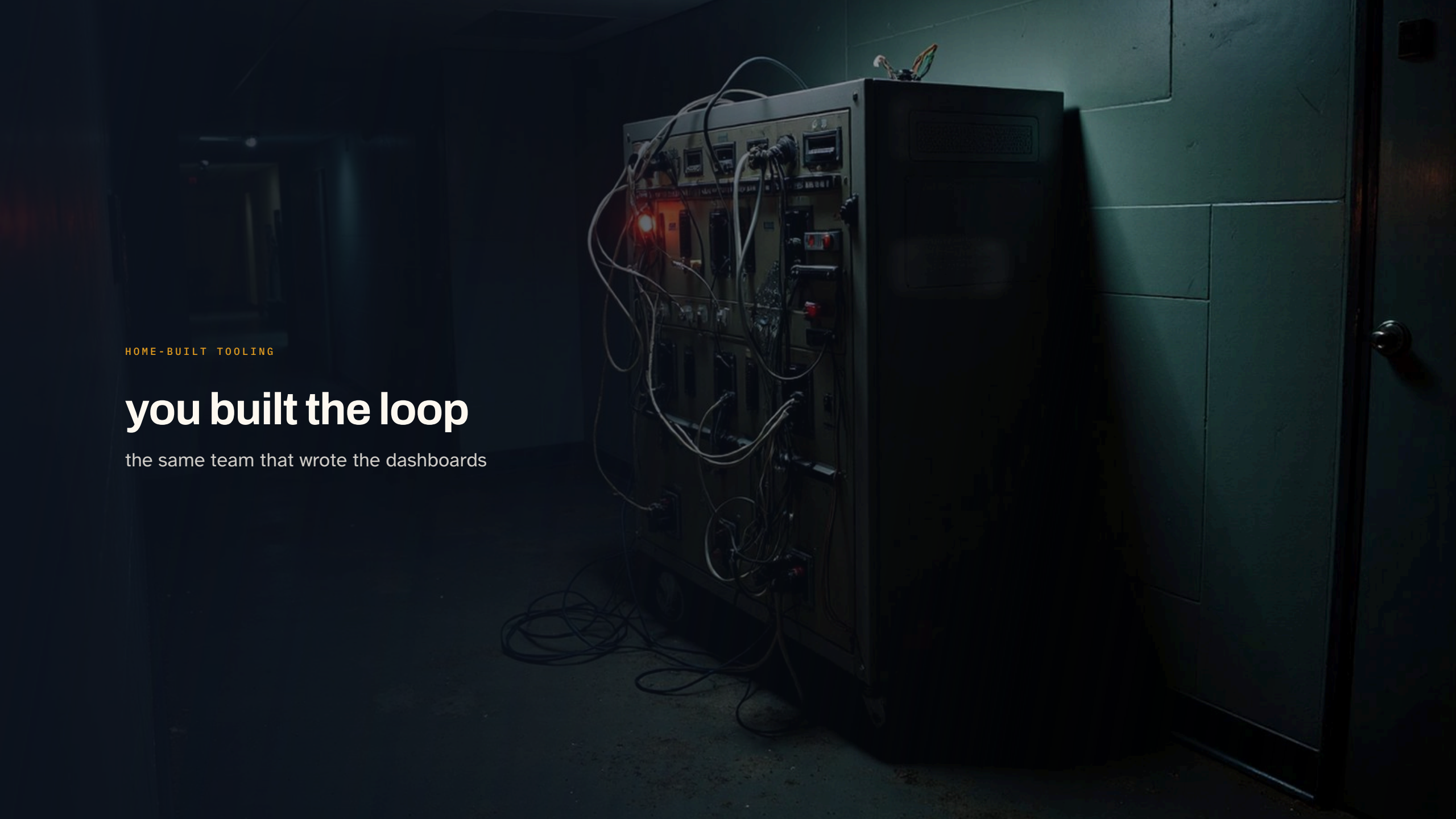
| Write the signal that separates two causes
before you look.

| Do not commit on evidence you went looking
for only because it fit.

A dimly lit room with a large window and an empty chair. The room is dark, with the primary light source being the window. The window is a large, multi-paned unit with a dark frame. Outside the window, a bright sun is visible in the sky, and dense green foliage is seen. In the center of the room, directly in front of the window, is a simple, dark-colored chair. The chair is empty. The walls are a light color, and a small framed picture is visible on the left wall. The floor is dark and reflective. The overall mood is quiet and contemplative.

the voice, none of the mandate

that chair is empty



HOME-BUILT TOOLING

you built the loop

the same team that wrote the dashboards

**One incident,
twice.**





THE CLOSED LOOP

the pool never came up

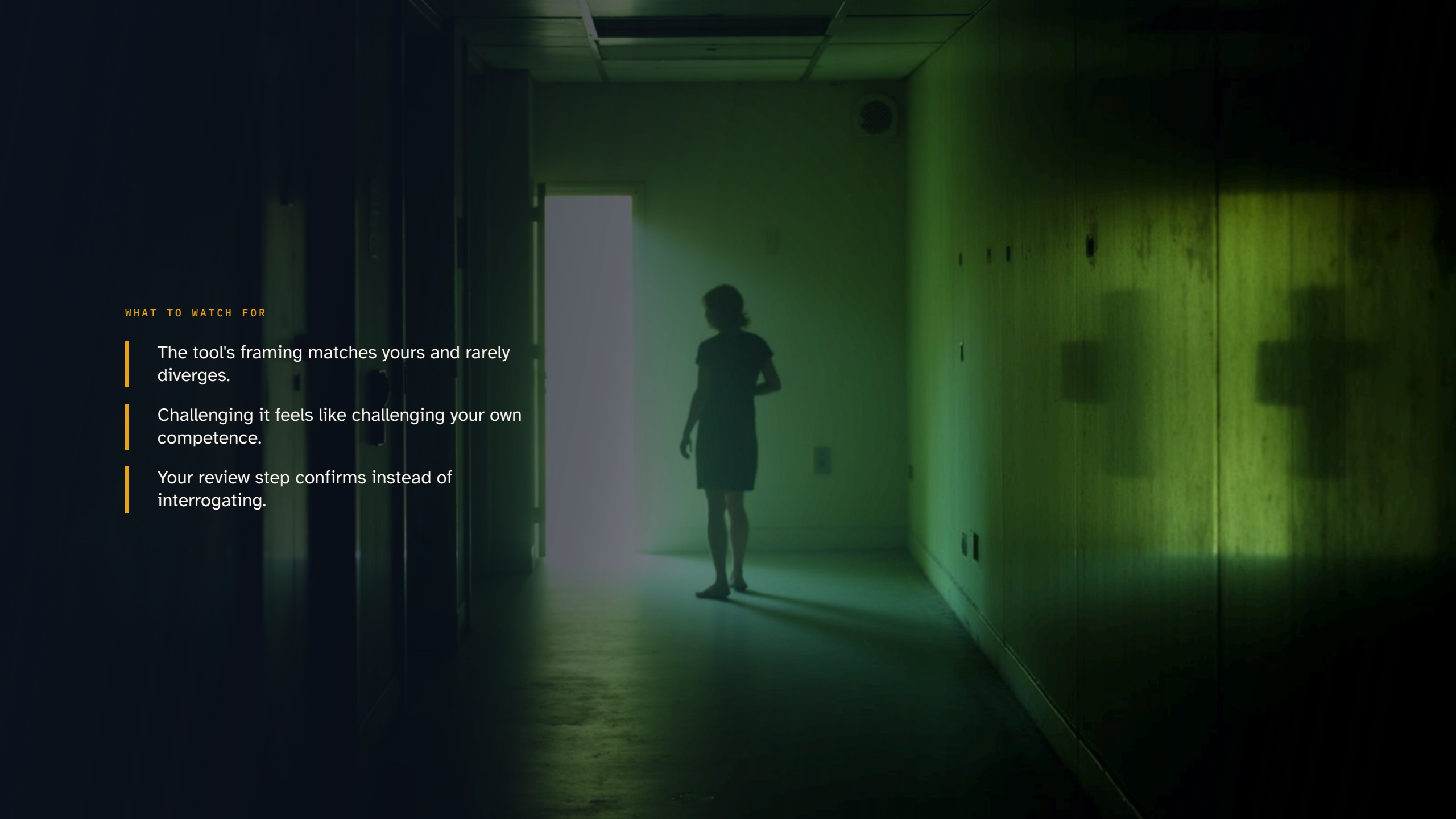
the words connection pool

THE SAME INCIDENT, WITH A CONTRACT

CAUSE	SIGNAL	EXPECT IF TRUE	COUNTS AGAINST
cache eviction	eviction rate	elevated	flat
pool starvation	pool saturation	near limit	headroom
bad deploy	errors by build	spike at rollout	flat

written before you look

pool saturation, named before you looked

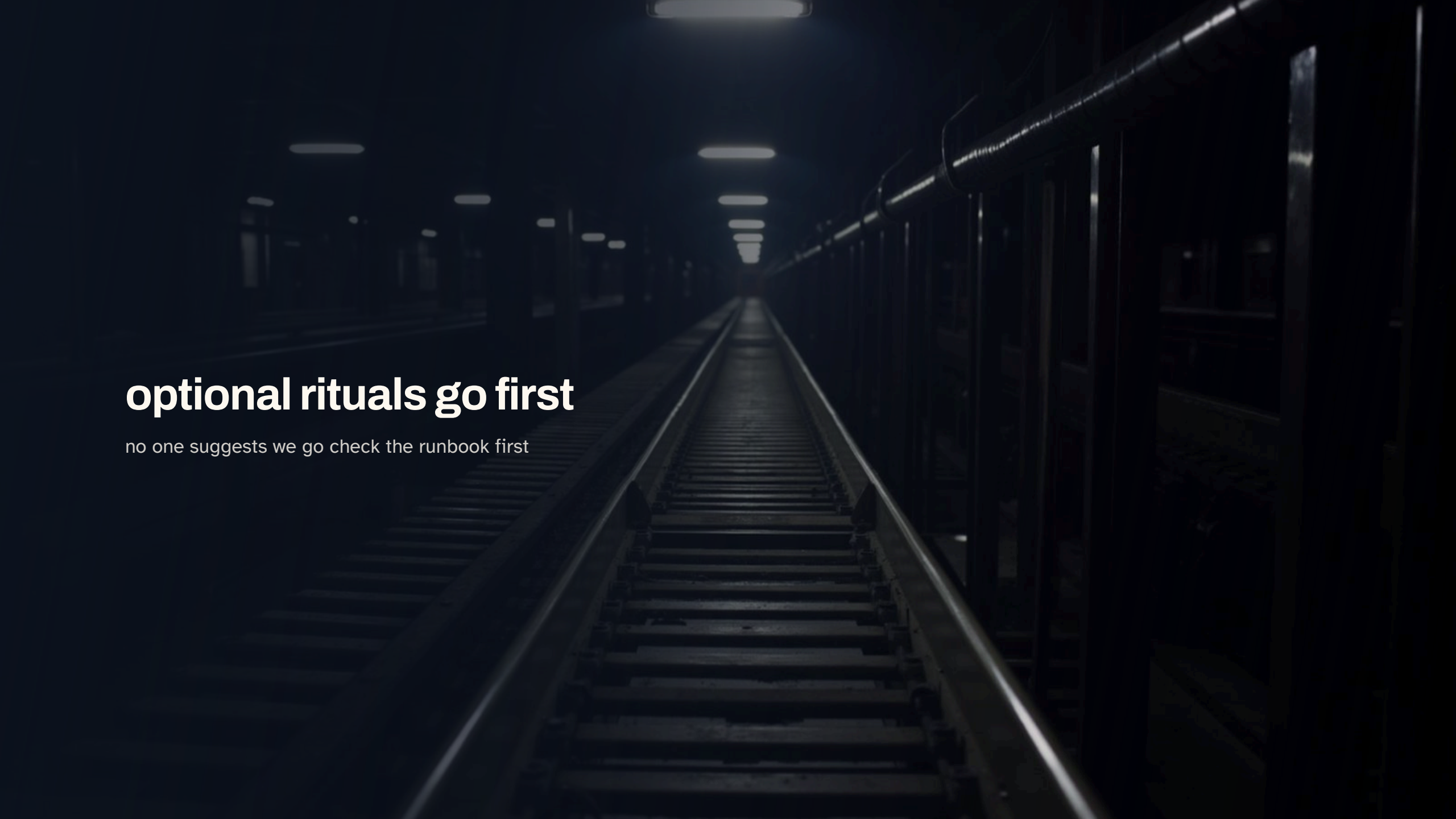
A woman in a dark dress stands in the center of a dark hallway, looking towards a bright doorway at the far end. The hallway is dimly lit, with light streaming in from the doorway, creating a strong silhouette effect. The walls are dark, and the floor is also dark. The overall mood is mysterious and contemplative.

WHAT TO WATCH FOR

The tool's framing matches yours and rarely diverges.

Challenging it feels like challenging your own competence.

Your review step confirms instead of interrogating.

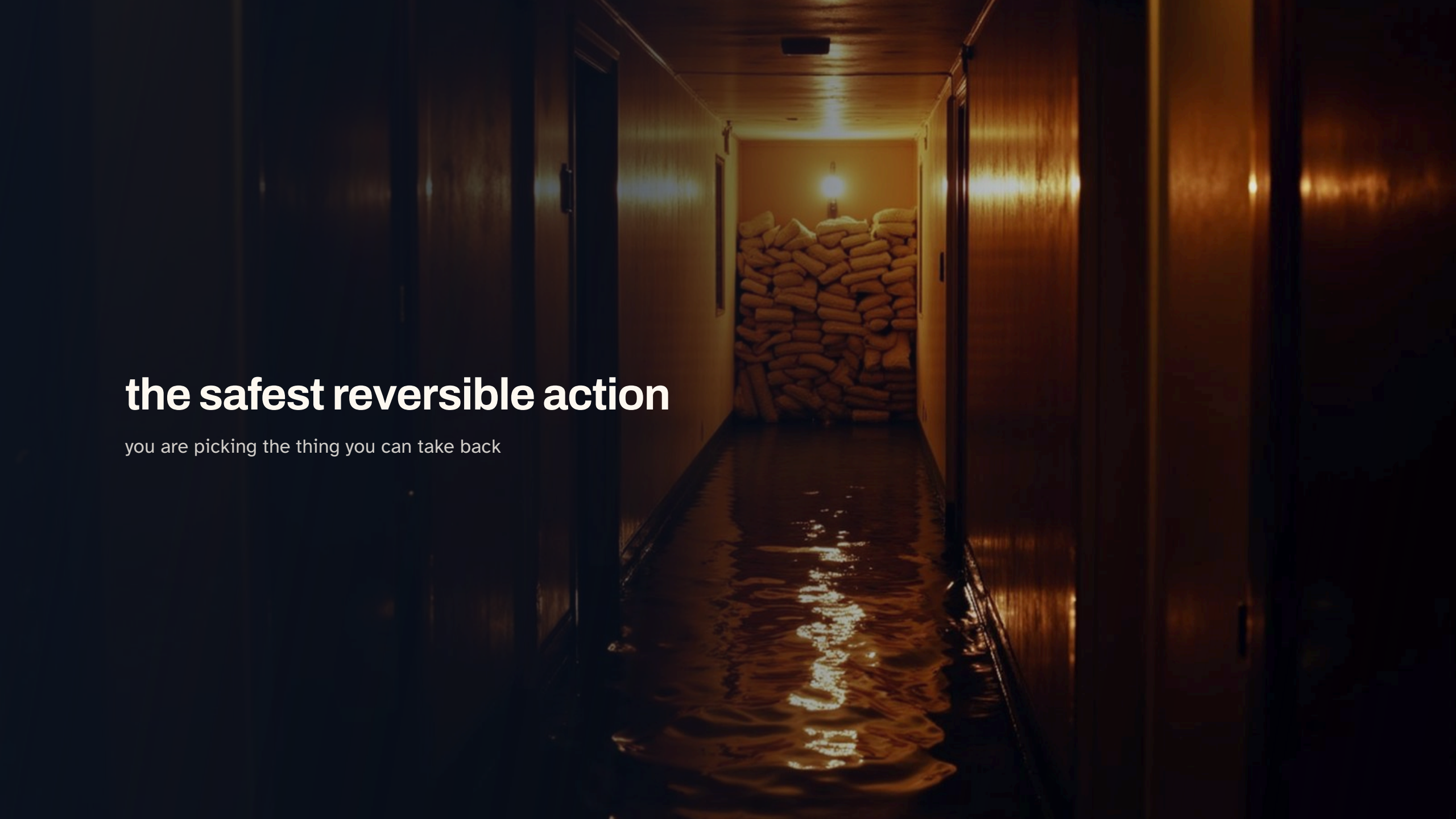


optional rituals go first

no one suggests we go check the runbook first

THE GATE, FILLED IN

Current read	cache eviction
Strongest rival	downstream pool saturation under retries
Separating signal	eviction rate versus pool utilization
Expect / window	pool $\geq$ 95% for 5 min, eviction at baseline
Counts against	eviction flat while latency climbs
Action	cap retries, shed optional traffic
Safe across rivals	yes, reduces load either way
Roll back if	errors +2 pts, or no improvement in 10 min
Break glass	IC may act now, reason and time recorded, retro required

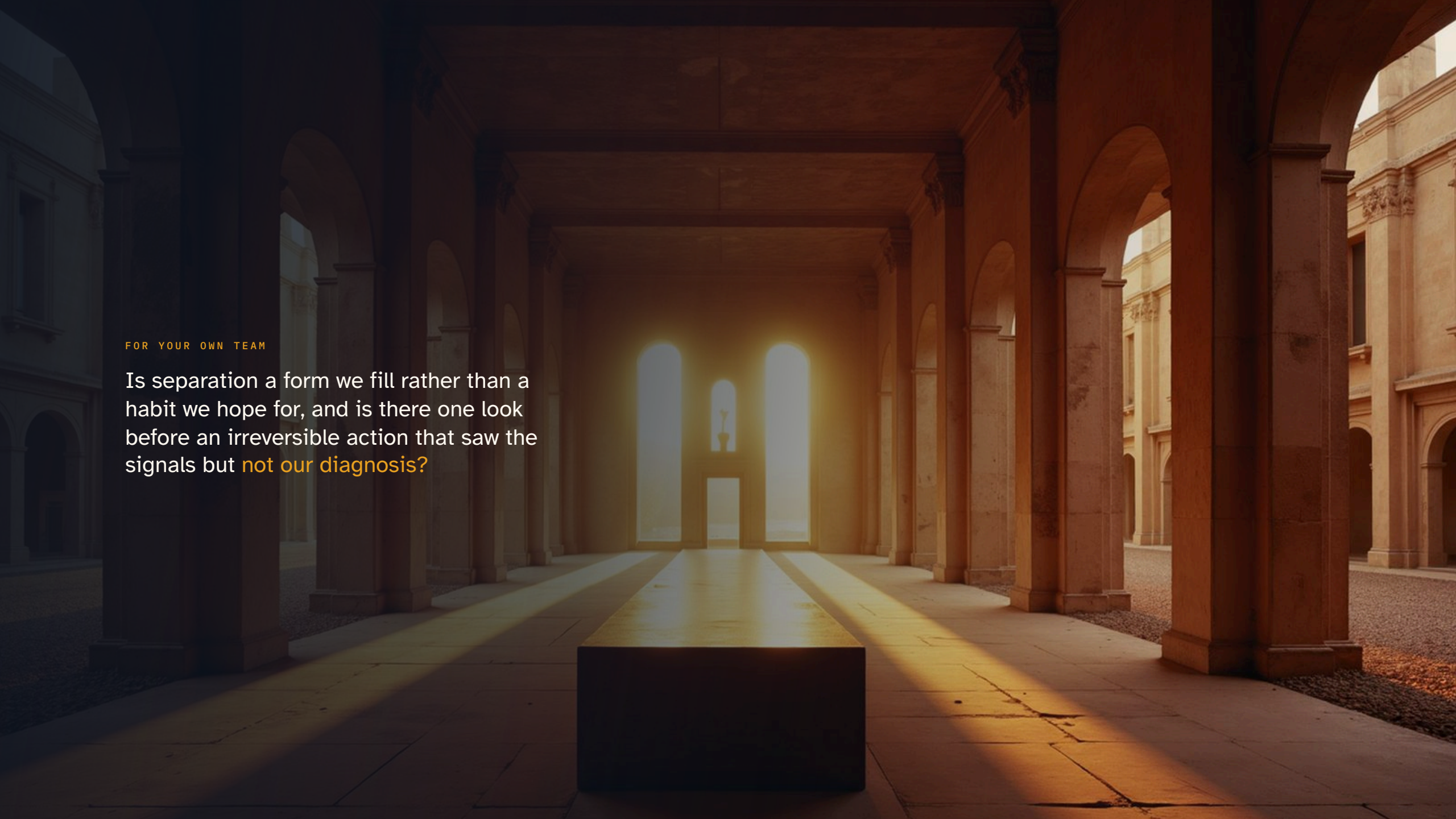


the safest reversible action

you are picking the thing you can take back

the signals, not the diagnosis

the graphs, and not your read



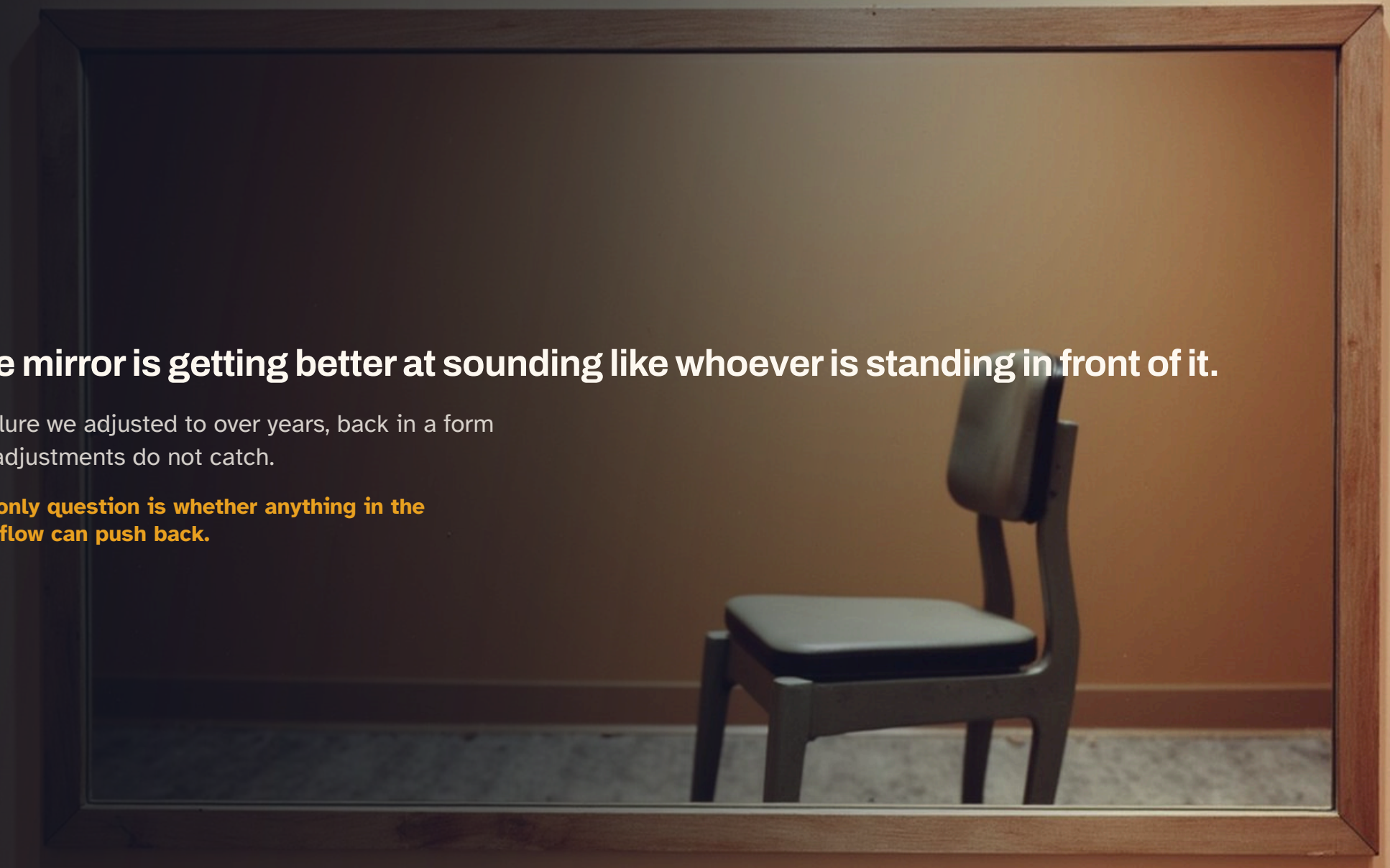
FOR YOUR OWN TEAM

Is separation a form we fill rather than a habit we hope for, and is there one look before an irreversible action that saw the signals but **not our diagnosis?**

The mirror is getting better at sounding like whoever is standing in front of it.

A failure we adjusted to over years, back in a form
our adjustments do not catch.

**The only question is whether anything in the
workflow can push back.**



BRIAN MORIARTY

Are You Talking to Me?



LINKEDIN

`/in/btmoriarty`



THE DECK

`hos1-research.github.io/manuscripts`